

MASIC: Information Systems Role & ERP System Case Study

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1. INTRODUCTION

The Information System (IS) has become one of the most critical computer technologies in recent times. It serves as the foundational backbone that helps organizations and global companies collect, store, manage, process, and securely share information. Structurally, an information system consists of several interdependent components working together: hardware (computers), software programs, data repositories, operational procedures, and the human resources who interact with them.

In the modern corporate era, information systems dramatically streamline organizational workflows. They structure, organize, visualize, and manage raw data in a highly accessible format, allowing human actors to interpret key insights easily. Consequently, IS is integrated into virtually every business sector and field to enhance competitive advantages, optimize operational efficiency, and drive total output. A premier example of a critical enterprise system is the Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) suite. In this comprehensive report, we utilize the integrated system architecture of **MASIC Investment Company** as our core empirical case study.

2. DESCRIPTION OF MASIC

MASIC is a prominent, highly structured investment organization whose primary business operation centers on strategic capital deployment and asset management. Founded more than 60 years ago as a shared enterprise between two cousins, the organization has scaled significantly over the decades. Today, MASIC manages a diverse, multi-asset portfolio encompassing real estate investment and development, liquid assets, local equity markets, and global international stock markets.

To manage its extensive enterprise data and back-office operations, MASIC utilizes an **ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning)** system to orchestrate its core financial frameworks, application processing, and procurement operations. Specifically, the company deploys **Microsoft Dynamics** as its centralized ERP platform. The IT department successfully finalized the system implementation cycle approximately one year ago, achieving a remarkably smooth, seamless, and successful transition. In tandem with the central ERP software, MASIC operates dedicated business-specific applications, most notably a robust **Property Management System** tailored to manage all real estate operational pipelines, leasing logs, and facility activities.

3. THE ROLE OF EXISTING IS

The strategic role of the active information system within an investment firm like MASIC is to catalog deep, historical data regarding client portfolios, bought shares, and historical market transactions. Furthermore, it is critical for tracking every granular financial input and output that moves through the organization's corporate bank accounts.

Historically, investment firms heavily struggled with excessive physical paperwork to process administrative data and transactional outputs. The introduction of a modern enterprise information system has drastically minimized physical paperwork,

consolidating all sensitive files into accessible, secure digital directory structures. This infrastructure allows analysts to instantly retrieve client transaction records spanning over 50 years. Ultimately, the system has made tracking, auditing, and maintaining complex financial and corporate data simpler, faster, and highly secure.

4. DESCRIPTION OF STAKEHOLDERS, BUSINESS NEEDS, & TECHNICAL FACTORS

Stakeholders and Market Dynamics

In terms of real estate development, MASIC's commercial portfolio prioritizes the provisioning and leasing of corporate offices and retail shops. Therefore, major corporate companies constitute a key stakeholder segment. Beyond commercial leasing, MASIC's core mission centers on serving the **Al-Subaie family business**, directly managing their extensive private wealth, local real estate holdings, private equity, and venture capital funds. Thus, the Al-Subaie family represents the primary corporate client and core stakeholder driving system demands.

Business and Technical Requirements

From an investment and technical perspective, MASIC actively pursues end-to-end automation and the deployment of strategic systems capable of generating streamlined, user-friendly executive reporting. To achieve this, the organization has placed a heavy strategic focus throughout 2024 on developing interactive **Business Intelligence (BI) dashboards**. Concurrently, the IT team performs routine software enhancements and agile modifications to keep auxiliary business applications aligned with evolving business demands.

An organization's technical and operational needs dictate how it approaches complex systemic bottlenecks. For an investment institution like MASIC, an effective information system is a prerequisite for achieving long-term strategic objectives. System updates are strictly determined by the need to guarantee data persistence, information safety, and absolute data integrity within the corporate database.

In a fast-paced digital economy, corporate assets can easily be exposed to distortion or fraudulent activities. Given the rapid economic growth of the region, maintaining client trust and data integrity takes precedence over raw sales volume. Loyal investors constitute the foundational pillars of the firm. To ensure alignment, MASIC's IT management team emphasizes that before any architectural decisions or system features are finalized, they must map directly to the organization's objective: reducing UI/UX complexity, tracking potential and existing loyal investors, and preserving institutional integrity.

5. DESCRIPTION OF THE EXPERIENCE IN THE PROJECT

Participating in this project has been a deeply rewarding academic and practical experience that has significantly expanded my technical horizon. Conducting field research, analyzing a 60-year-old investment institution, and witnessing how they interface with elite clients provided profound insights into professional systems engineering.

Seeing how MASIC continuously refines and patches its enterprise systems to ensure user experience remains a top priority has demystified the practical realities of IT operations. As an Information Systems student, this fieldwork provided an inspiring glimpse into my future career potential, showing how closely aligned our field is with the country's visionary future and digital transformation plans. While the transition to the professional tech space initially seemed intimidating, executing this system analysis has instilled immense confidence in my analytical capabilities.

6. CONCLUSION

In conclusion, this project evaluated how specialized information systems transform traditional corporate workflows into simple, scalable, and highly optimized digital architectures. We explored the technical issues businesses face during implementation, the methodologies used to solve them, and the profound impact an integrated system has on organizational growth.

Ultimately, this analysis reinforces that **ERP systems** stand as the most vital software infrastructure for modern enterprises. In the contemporary corporate environment, there is simply no path to business scalability, operational safety, or commercial success without a robust Information System at its core.

7. REFERENCE

- MASIC Official Corporate Platform: <https://masic.com.sa/>